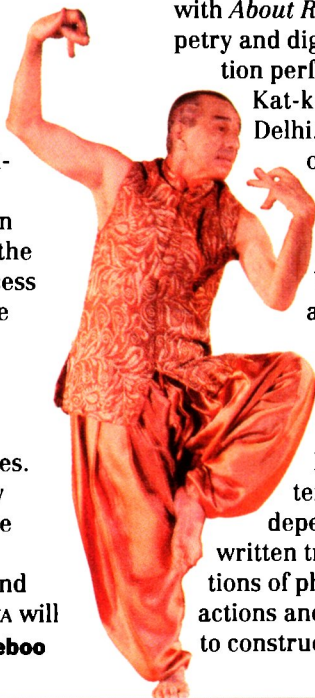


festival Rhythm Divine

BANGALORE New performances that involve extensive research and experimentation often have to face a resource crunch—from that of time to funds to infrastructure.

The India Foundation for the Arts (IFA) has tried to eliminate these limitations in order to let the artistic process flourish. The effort is to create and break new ground for performances.

The New Performance Festival presented and funded by IFA will **IN STEP: Deboo**



see four new productions from across the country. They use new media like shadow puppetry and animation to explore themes inspired by traditional art forms like Pung-cholom, Bharatnatyam, poetry and visual arts.

The festival begins with *About Ram*, a puppetry and digital animation performance by Kat-katha from Delhi. It moves on to *Quick Death* by Theatre Roots & Wings, authored by Australian playwright Richard Murphet, a text that depends on written transcriptions of physical actions and gestures to construct the

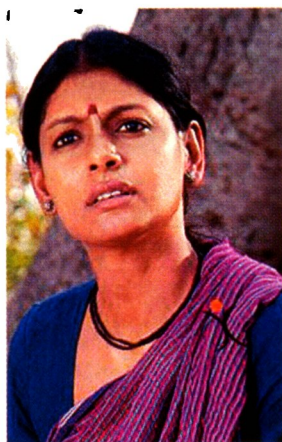
theme, plot, character and spectacle. *The Rhythm Divine* is a new dance production which is a collaboration between Astad Deboo and the Pungcholom drummers. "Its new art forms talk to each other in a contemporary way," says Deboo. Guru Seityaban of the Pungcholom drummers and Deboo create movements replicated by the other—referred to as *sawaal jawaab* with movement and rhythm.

The festival ends with *Vyuti—Inflections*, a performance by Anusha Lall and Giti Thadani, which reinterprets Bharatnatyam, giving the form new architectural dimensions through light and image installations. Between February 23 and 29 at Ranga Shankara.

by **Nirmala Ravindran**

recommendations Gender Issues

CHENNAI The First Women's Film Festival explores gender issues with all the feminist connotations, the perspective problem and the alternative to the patriarchal system with 84 feature films. That there are no answers to these complex issues will be best described by *Meghe Dhaka Taara* by Ritwik Ghatak, the only male director at the festival. Stalwarts like Aparna Sen, Chitra Palekar, Mira Nair, Kim Soyoun of Korea, Tanuja Chandra and Revathy join world cinema from



WOMAN POWER: Nandita Das in Palekar's Maati Maay Iran, Mexico, and Burkina Faso. Between March 1 and 8.

by **Minu Ittyape**

DELHI Author-scholar Pran Neville pays tribute to ghazal queen Malika

Pukhraj—who sang the evergreen *Abhi toh main jawan hoon*—in a talk, *The Magic of Malika Pukhraj: From Gramophone to Radio and TV Era*. This will be followed by a musical homage by Hindustani classical singer Rashmi Agarwal. At the India International Centre on March 1.

DELHI Water colour exponent Umesh Prasad displays his recent works in acrylic on canvas at Mulk Raj Anand Centre. A product of College of Arts and Crafts, Patna, he tries to play on the image of 'zero'. From February 22 to 28.

theatre Perfect Play

KOLKATA Thirty die-hard theatre enthusiasts participate in a three-month-long Hindi drama workshop organised by Sangeet Natak Academy. The play *Gardish* will be staged first on March 4, and it is at this workshop that all aspects of dramatic skills of actors will be honed. The script is based on how villagers are tortured and traumatised by the police and how they finally rise in revolt.

by **Elora Sen**

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